

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 978

By McKenzie

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Diane Jordan of Knox County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Diane Jordan of Knox County; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Jordan was a trailblazing figure in local politics and always recognizable by the statement hats she wore; she was a devoted public servant who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Diane Jordan, who was seventy-eight years old when she passed, was the first Black woman to serve on the Knox County Commission; her tenure spanned from 1994 to 2007, during which time she was a Democrat representing District 6; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Jordan first ran for office with the intention of shining a light on police brutality, which she said permeated her predominantly Black district; after her first term, she told a local news outlet, "that has dropped off considerably since now it's out in the open." During her second term as a Knox County commissioner, she shifted her focus to economic development; and

WHEREAS, her public and private industry careers were expansive; after her political career came to a close, she continued to serve her community in various capacities, including as a member of the Beck Cultural Center's Board of Directors, Drug Free America, and the Knoxville NAACP. She also served on the Knox County Election Commission; and

WHEREAS, a graduate of Austin-East Magnet High School, Mrs. Jordan worked in reservations for Delta Airlines for twenty years; she obtained her real estate license in the 1990s and was one of the few women in Knox County to hold an auctioneer's license; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Jordan was often duly lauded for the positive impact she had on Knox County; she was the recipient of the YWCA's 1990 Tribute to Women Award for volunteer service, and in 2017, the Interstate 275 bridge over Elm Street/Bernard Avenue was renamed "Diane Jordan Pass" in her honor; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her important work throughout the community, Mrs. Jordan was known for her extensive hat collection that included more than 125 cowboy hats and over 250 Sunday hats, which she donned as First Lady of her church; and

WHEREAS, a beloved family matriarch, Diane Jordan is survived by her husband of forty-one years, Reverend John Jordan; eight children; and more than twenty grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Jordan's life stands as a powerful testament to service, excellence, and perseverance; her legacy is woven into the fabric of her community and will endure for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Diane Jordan, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Jordan.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.